Task 3 – Basic Vulnerability Scan

Assessment tool	Greenbone OpenVAS / Greenbone Security Assistant
Environment	Kali Linux with OpenVAS running in a Docker-based lab
Scan status	Completed
Finding observed	TCP timestamps – Low severity

1. Purpose

The purpose of this task was to run a basic vulnerability scan on an authorized lab system, review the results, and understand the security issue identified by the scanner. The host address has been left out of this report for privacy.

2. Steps Followed

1. Opened the Greenbone Security Assistant web interface.
2. Created a scan target for the authorized lab machine.
3. Created a scan task and selected an available scan configuration.
4. Started the scan and waited until the task status changed to Done.
5. Opened the generated report and checked the severity summary.
6. Selected the TCP timestamps finding to review its details and suggested fix.
7. Captured the relevant screenshots and kept host details private.

3. Scan Result

The completed report showed one Low-severity finding and four Log results. The finding identified was TCP timestamps, with a severity score of 2.6 and a Quality of Detection (QoD) of 80%. No High- or Medium-severity findings were shown in the report summary.

4. Finding: TCP Timestamps

The scan detected that the host responds with TCP timestamp information. In some situations, this information may help someone estimate how long a system has been running. This is considered a low-impact information disclosure issue and does not, by itself, mean that the system has been compromised.

5. Recommended Mitigation

If TCP timestamps are not required, the system administrator can disable them after checking that the change will not affect normal network operations. The scanner report provides a Linux setting (net.ipv4.tcp_timestamps = 0) and a Windows netsh-based option. Apply changes only with permission, then run another scan to confirm whether the finding has been resolved.

6. Conclusion

This task provided practical experience in setting up a scan, running it, and reviewing the results using OpenVAS. The scan identified a Low-severity TCP timestamps finding. The recommended mitigation has been recorded, and a follow-up scan can be used to verify the change after it is approved and applied.

7. Scan Evidence

The screenshots below show the completed scan, the report result, and the details of the TCP timestamps finding. The host address is not included in this document.

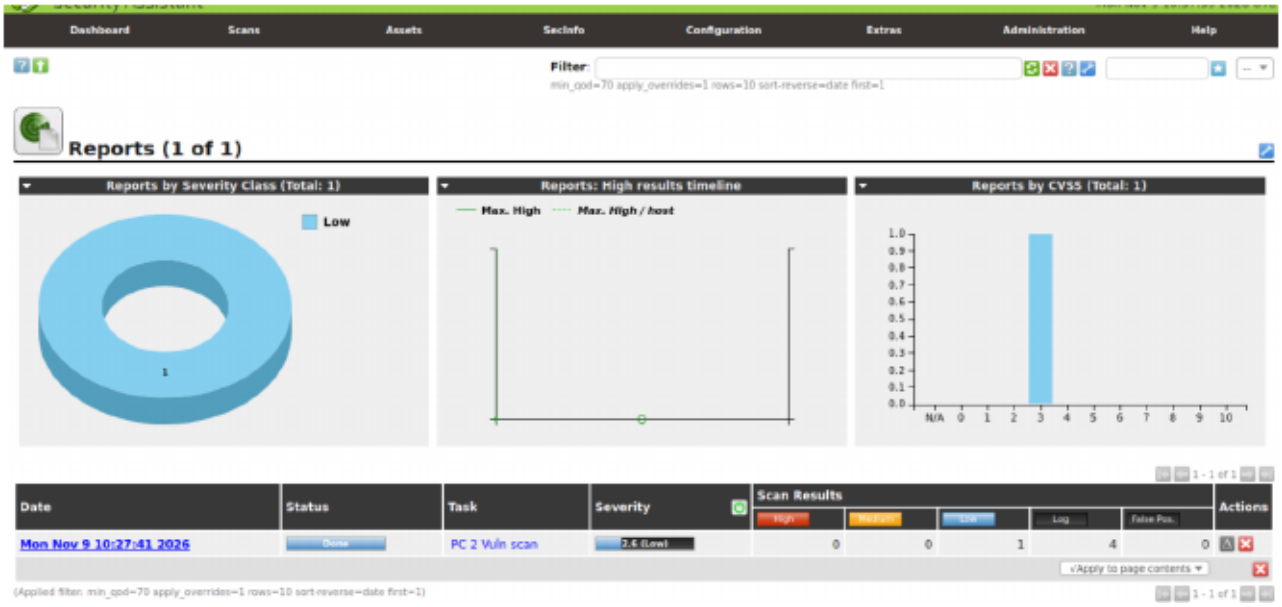


Figure 1. Completed scan report overview.

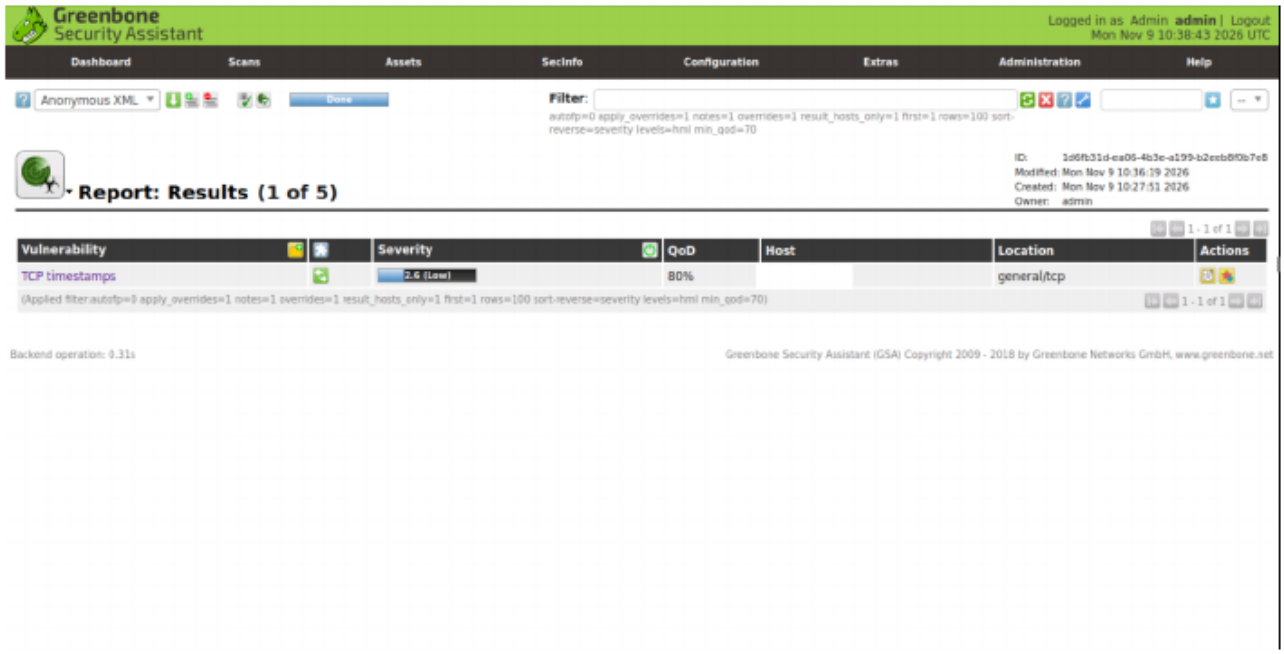


Figure 2. Report results showing the TCP timestamps finding.

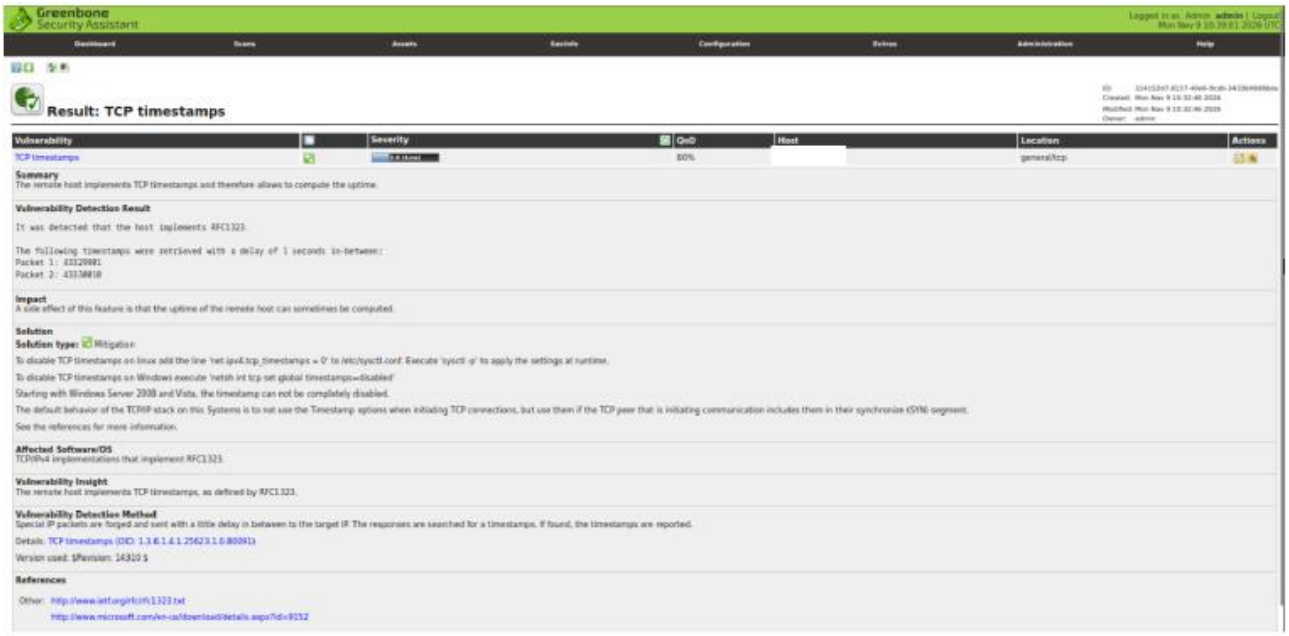


Figure 3. Details of the TCP timestamps finding and suggested mitigation.